

Edwards Lifesciences Corporation (NYSE: EW)

Comprehensive Company Knowledge Reference

Compiled for retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) knowledge base use. Covers company overview, leadership, financials, competitive landscape, strategy, manufacturing footprint, ownership, governance, risks, and outlook.

Document compiled: September 2026. Sourced from Edwards Lifesciences SEC filings (10-K, 8-K, DEF 14A / proxy statement), company press releases, investor relations materials, and third-party market research and financial data providers. Figures for fiscal year 2026 partial-year periods reflect guidance and reported quarterly results available as of the compilation date and are subject to revision in subsequent filings.

1. Company Overview

Edwards Lifesciences Corporation is an American medical technology company headquartered in Irvine, California. It describes itself as the leading global structural heart innovation company, focused exclusively on structural heart disease and, historically, critical care monitoring. The company designs, manufactures, and markets products used to treat advanced cardiovascular disease, with a specific focus on heart valve disease and hemodynamic monitoring.

Edwards was spun off from Baxter International in 2000 and trades on the New York Stock Exchange under the ticker symbol EW. The company traces its origins to 1958, when Miles “Lowell” Edwards partnered with Dr. Albert Starr, using a \$5,000 investment from Edwards to develop the Starr-Edwards mitral valve, widely regarded as the first commercially available artificial heart valve. This heritage underlies the company's positioning as a pioneer in structural heart therapy.

1.1 Key Corporate Facts

Attribute	Detail
Legal name	Edwards Lifesciences Corporation
Ticker / Exchange	NYSE: EW
Headquarters	One Edwards Way, Irvine, California, USA 92614
Founded / Spin-off	Heritage to 1958 (Starr-Edwards valve); spun off from Baxter International in 2000
CEO	Bernard J. Zovighian (since May 2023)
Industry	Medical devices — structural heart / cardiovascular devices (surgical devices, medical equipment & supplies)
Employees (approx.)	~14,000–16,000 worldwide (estimates vary by source; ~15,700 per 2026 workforce data)
Market capitalization (2026)	~\$52 billion (as of late August 2026, ~576 million shares outstanding)
Share price (late Aug 2026)	~\$90.75
International sales mix	Approximately 60% of total sales generated outside the United States

1.2 Business Segments / Product Groups

Following the 2024 divestiture of a significant portion of its Critical Care (patient monitoring) business to Becton Dickinson (BD), Edwards has narrowed its focus almost entirely to structural heart disease. The company organizes its business into the following primary product groups:

- **Transcatheter Aortic Valve Replacement (TAVR):** Edwards' largest and most mature product group, built around the SAPIEN platform (SAPIEN 3, SAPIEN 3 Ultra, SAPIEN 3 Ultra Resilia). TAVR devices are delivered via catheter to replace a diseased aortic valve without open-heart surgery.
- **Transcatheter Mitral and Tricuspid Therapies (TMTT):** Edwards' newest and fastest-growing product group, addressing mitral and tricuspid valve disease through repair and replacement technologies including the PASCAL repair system, EVOQUE tricuspid replacement system, and SAPIEN M3 mitral replacement system.
- **Surgical Structural Heart (Surgical):** Traditional surgical tissue heart valves and repair products used in open-heart surgery, building on the company's original heart valve heritage.

- **Critical Care (largely divested):** Historically included hemodynamic monitoring systems (e.g., Swan-Ganz catheters, FloTrac, Acumen); the bulk of this business was sold to BD (Becton, Dickinson and Company) in 2024, though Edwards retained certain related revenue streams (e.g., Implantable Heart Failure Management/IHFM) reported within TMTT.

2. Leadership, CEO, and Executive Team

2.1 Chief Executive Officer

Bernard J. Zovighian has served as Chief Executive Officer of Edwards Lifesciences and as a member of its Board of Directors since May 2023 (age 57–58 as reported in 2026 filings). He joined Edwards in 2015 and held a series of senior leadership roles before becoming CEO:

- President of Edwards Lifesciences, January 2023 to May 2023
- Corporate Vice President, Transcatheter Mitral and Tricuspid Therapies (TMTT), 2018 to 2023
- Vice President, then Corporate Vice President, Surgical Structural Heart, 2015 to 2018
- Prior to Edwards: nearly 20 years at Johnson & Johnson (1995–2014) in roles of increasing responsibility, including worldwide president of one of J&J's divisions

Zovighian's career spans more than three decades in medical technology, with experience leading global businesses across multiple countries. His compensation for fiscal year 2025 was reported at approximately \$17.5 million in total compensation, up about 19% from roughly \$14.5 million in 2024. This package included a base salary of about \$1.2 million, \$7.1 million in stock awards, \$6.5 million in option awards, a \$2.4 million cash performance bonus, and approximately \$189,000 in other compensation (including deferred compensation plan matching, 401(k) matching, and security/personal benefits).

2.2 Chief Financial Officer

Theodora (“Doretta”) Mistras became Corporate Vice President and Chief Financial Officer of Edwards Lifesciences effective at the end of May 2026, succeeding Scott B. Ullem, who announced his planned transition from the CFO role in October 2025. Mistras joined Edwards from Viatris, a global pharmaceutical company, where she served as CFO beginning in March 2024. Earlier in her career she was a managing director in healthcare investment banking at Citigroup Global Markets and held senior healthcare investment banking leadership roles at Goldman Sachs. She holds bachelor's degrees in international studies and economics from the University of Pennsylvania and the Wharton School, respectively. She also serves on the board of overseers for the Gennadius Library of the American School of Classical Studies and on the board of trustees of Leadership 100.

2.3 Other Notable Executives

- **Amit Agarwal** — Senior Vice President, Transcatheter Edge-to-Edge Repair (TEER) therapies, joined January 2026 from Medtronic's Cardiac Ablation Solutions division, where he was Vice President, Global Marketing and Strategy.
- **Todd J. Brinton** — Corporate Vice President, Advanced Technology (per company/third-party executive listings).
- **Scott B. Ullem** — Former Corporate Vice President and CFO; announced transition from the role in October 2025, succeeded by Mistras in 2026.
- Edwards' broader executive/leadership bench (per company and third-party data) totals over 20 named senior executives spanning R&D, clinical affairs, regulatory, global commercial organizations, quality, and regional leadership (Europe, Asia-Pacific, Japan, etc.).

2.4 Board of Directors

Edwards' Board of Directors nominated nine individuals for election at the 2026 Annual Meeting. CEO Bernard Zovoghian sits on the Board as a director. The Board includes a mix of medtech, healthcare, finance, and governance expertise; Board members provide oversight of Edwards' patient-focused innovation strategy, capital allocation, executive compensation, and risk management. The Board chairmanship and committee structure (audit, compensation, nominating/governance, and compliance-related committees) follow customary large-cap public company governance practice, with proxy advisers such as ISS and Glass Lewis, and major index-fund shareholders, exerting meaningful influence over governance votes (executive compensation, board declassification, and ESG-related disclosures have been recurring proxy themes in recent years).

3. Financial Performance and Revenue

3.1 Historical Annual Revenue

Fiscal Year	Net Sales	YoY Growth
2023	\$5,010.0 million	—
2024	\$5,439.5 million	+8.6%
2025	\$6,067.6 million (~\$6.07B)	+11.5% (10.7% constant currency)
TTM ending June 30, 2026	~\$6.51 billion	+14.6% YoY

Edwards has guided full-year 2026 total company sales toward a range of approximately \$6.5–\$6.9 billion, reflecting a raised sales growth guidance of 9–11% (up from an initial 8–10%) following stronger-than-expected first-quarter 2026 results.

3.2 Profitability

Full-year 2025 GAAP operating income was approximately \$1,264.2 million, down from \$1,378.7 million in 2024 and \$1,308.9 million in 2023, reflecting the impact of intellectual property/litigation expenses (~\$325.4 million in 2025), an impairment charge, and other one-time items. Reported (GAAP) net income for 2025 was approximately \$1.074 billion, a sharp decline (~74%) from 2024's \$4.175 billion — the 2024 figure was substantially inflated by a large gain associated with the Critical Care divestiture to BD, making 2024 net income not directly comparable to other years. 2023 net income was approximately \$1.402 billion. Fourth-quarter 2025 gross margin remained strong at roughly 78.1%, though GAAP operating margin compressed to about 9.6% (from 22.6% a year earlier) due to litigation and impairment charges, and the effective tax rate rose to about 29.0% from 11.6%.

3.3 Segment / Product Group Performance (Recent Quarters)

- **TAVR:** Edwards' largest product line by revenue. Q4 2025 TAVR sales grew approximately 12.0% (10.6% constant currency) to about \$1.16 billion. Full-year 2026 TAVR sales guidance is approximately \$4.7–\$5.0 billion.
- **TMTT:** The fastest-growing product group. Q4 2025 TMTT sales grew more than 40% year-over-year to \$156 million, with full-year 2025 TMTT sales exceeding \$0.5 billion. Full-year 2026 TMTT guidance calls for sales of \$740–\$780 million, implying roughly 35–45% growth, driven by adoption of PASCAL, EVOQUE, and (pending approval) SAPIEN M3.
- **Surgical:** A mature, stable product group; company guidance points to mid-single-digit sales growth in Surgical for 2026.

3.4 2026 Guidance Summary (as raised during the year)

Metric	Guidance (2026)
Total company sales	\$6.5–\$6.9 billion (constant-currency growth of 9–11%)
TAVR sales	\$4.7–\$5.0 billion (constant-currency growth of 7–9%)
TMTT sales	\$740–\$780 million (35–45% growth)

Surgical growth	Mid-single-digit sales growth
Adjusted EPS	\$2.95–\$3.05 (raised from \$2.90–\$3.05)
Q2 2026 guidance (given post-Q1)	Total sales \$1.66–\$1.74B; adjusted EPS \$0.70–\$0.76

3.5 Capital Allocation

Edwards has historically returned capital to shareholders primarily through share repurchases rather than dividends; buyback programs from 2022–2024 totaled multiple billions of dollars, with additional authorizations continuing into 2025, modestly supporting per-share earnings. The company does not have a history of paying a regular common stock dividend, instead prioritizing reinvestment in R&D;, clinical evidence generation, selective M&A;/licensing, and buybacks.

4. Competitive Landscape

Edwards Lifesciences competes in the broader structural heart device market, where the top five companies by market share — Medtronic, Abbott, Boston Scientific, LivaNova, and Edwards itself — collectively accounted for over 78% of the global structural heart market in 2025, reflecting a highly concentrated competitive landscape.

4.1 Primary Competitors by Segment

Competitor	Primary Area of Competition
Medtronic	TAVR (CoreValve / Evolut FX / Evolut PRO+ self-expanding platform)
Abbott Laboratories	TAVR (Navitor); Mitral repair (MitraClip, ~60% global share of that segment); Tricuspid (TriClip)
Boston Scientific	TAVR (ACURATE neo2, sold in Europe; exited then reportedly re-entering the U.S. TAVR market)
LivaNova	Broader structural heart / cardiac surgery portfolio
Emerging/private entrants	TAVR, tricuspid replacement (e.g., Vdyne developing a TTVR system), mitral (e.g., Anteris Technology)
Philips, GE HealthCare, Getinge	Adjacent monitoring / cardiac surgery equipment

4.2 TAVR Market Share

Edwards has historically dominated the global TAVR market, having pioneered percutaneous aortic valve replacement. Third-party market research estimates place Edwards' global TAVR share at roughly 55–60%, and its U.S. share as high as approximately 60–72% depending on the source and year, with Medtronic a clear second (roughly 24–28% worldwide/U.S.). Abbott's Navitor has captured a small but growing share (low single digits in the U.S., mid single digits worldwide) since its U.S. launch in 2023. Analysts have flagged a risk of gradual share erosion for Edwards as the U.S. TAVR market matures and growth decelerates, with new entrants such as Boston Scientific and Abbott intensifying competition; however, Edwards management has emphasized the depth of its clinical evidence base and its status as the long-standing global share leader as durable competitive advantages.

4.3 Competitive Positioning and Strategic Response

Edwards frames its competitive strategy around three pillars: (1) focusing exclusively on structural heart disease rather than diversifying into adjacent medtech categories, (2) targeting large, urgent, and clinically complex unmet patient needs, and (3) pursuing differentiated innovation and evidence generation (e.g., large randomized trials such as EARLY TAVR, TRISCEND II, and PROGRESS) to sustain premium positioning, physician trust, and procedural volume advantages rather than compete primarily on price.

5. Strategy, Pipeline, and Future Expansion

5.1 Strategic Priorities

At its December 2025 investor conference, Edwards reaffirmed a strategy centered on sustainable, differentiated growth across its three product groups, with continued heavy investment in clinical evidence generation to expand indications, support reimbursement, and drive physician and patient adoption.

5.2 Key Near-Term Regulatory and Clinical Milestones (2026–2027)

- U.S. TAVR clinical guideline updates expected by Q4 2026
- Updated U.S. TAVR National Coverage Determination (NCD) expected by Q4 2026, which could expand the eligible Medicare patient population
- Presentation of PROGRESS trial data (studying treatment of moderate aortic stenosis patients) expected at TCT 2026 — a potential catalyst for expanding TAVR into earlier-stage disease
- FDA approval of SAPIEN M3, the world's first transcatheter mitral valve replacement system, targeted for early 2026
- Launch of the next-generation PASCAL system and FDA approval of PASCAL for tricuspid regurgitation (TR) expected in Q4 2026
- TRISCEND II two-year data on the EVOQUE tricuspid valve expected Q2 2026, with next-generation EVOQUE technology expected in the second half of 2027

These milestones represent Edwards' primary levers for expanding its addressable patient population: moving TAVR “upstream” into earlier/moderate disease stages, and building out a full suite of mitral and tricuspid repair/replacement options (PASCAL, EVOQUE, SAPIEN M3) to capture what management describes as a large underserved population — Edwards has cited over 20 million structural heart patients worldwide as the long-term addressable opportunity.

5.3 Manufacturing Footprint and Facility Expansion

Edwards operates a global manufacturing network supporting its heart valve and transcatheter device production. Historical and current manufacturing locations include:

- Irvine, California, USA (global headquarters and manufacturing)
- Draper, Utah, USA
- Horw, Switzerland (heart valve manufacturing)
- Singapore (Changi North Crescent) — a major heart valve manufacturing hub, expanded in 2013 to roughly double capacity (~24,000 square meters) to meet global tissue heart valve demand
- Costa Rica (La Lima Free Zone, Cartago) — established circa 2016 as an additional production facility, with planned headcount growth (initial hiring of ~150, aiming to double staffing by end of 2017)
- Dominican Republic
- Puerto Rico
- Limerick, Ireland — a newer manufacturing facility completed around 2021

This geographically diversified manufacturing base supports Edwards' global commercial footprint, with roughly 60% of total company sales generated outside the United States, and helps mitigate single-region supply chain and regulatory risk.

5.4 Workforce

Employee headcount estimates vary by data provider: Revelio Labs workforce data placed Edwards Lifesciences at approximately 15,736 employees worldwide as of March 2026 (essentially flat year-over-year), while PitchBook cites approximately 16,000 total employees and LeadIQ cites approximately 14,000 employees across six continents (North America, Europe, and Asia being the most cited regions). Total headcount has declined modestly since 2023 (from roughly 17,000), a trend partly attributable to the 2024 divestiture of a large portion of the Critical Care business to BD, which transferred associated employees to BD. Despite this, active job postings rose significantly (roughly +26% in 2026 versus the prior year), suggesting renewed hiring activity concentrated in growth areas such as TMTT.

6. Ownership and Stakeholders

6.1 Institutional Ownership

Edwards Lifesciences is a widely held, institutionally dominated public company. Institutional investors collectively hold roughly 85–89% of outstanding shares, according to various third-party ownership analyses, with individual/retail investors holding the balance (roughly 10–15%).

Shareholder	Approx. Ownership (varies by filing date/source)
The Vanguard Group, Inc.	~7.5–12% (largest single shareholder across most reports)
BlackRock, Inc.	~8.5–10.2%
State Street Global Advisors / State Street Corp	~4–6%
Wellington Management Group LLP	Notable active institutional holder (single-digit %)
JPMorgan Chase & Co.	Notable institutional holder
Bank of New York Mellon Corp, FMR LLC (Fidelity), Jennison Associates LLC	Additional large institutional holders

No single shareholder holds a controlling stake; the top ~16–23 institutional shareholders together account for roughly 50–51% of shares outstanding, indicating a broadly diversified ownership base rather than concentrated control. Edwards has approximately 2,000+ institutional owners/shareholders that have filed 13D/13G/13F forms with the SEC. Combined passive index-fund ownership (Vanguard, BlackRock, State Street) has generally exceeded 20–25% of shares outstanding in recent years, giving these firms' stewardship/proxy-voting teams meaningful influence over governance matters.

6.2 Governance Structure

Edwards has a single class of common stock on a one-share-one-vote basis (no dual-class shares or golden share structures). Insider ownership by directors and executives, including the CEO, represents a small percentage of total shares outstanding, consistent with typical large-cap public company practice. Recent governance-related proxy votes (2023–2025) have focused on topics such as board declassification, ESG disclosure practices, and executive compensation alignment with performance.

6.3 Other Key Stakeholders

- **Patients:** Edwards frames patients as its central stakeholder, citing an addressable population of over 20 million people worldwide affected by structural heart disease.
- **Physicians and hospital systems:** Interventional cardiologists, cardiac surgeons, and hospital purchasing/procedure teams are critical stakeholders whose adoption decisions and clinical trial participation directly drive commercial results.
- **Regulators:** The U.S. FDA (device approvals/clearances), CMS (Medicare coverage determinations, e.g., the TAVR National Coverage Determination), and international regulatory bodies (e.g., in Europe and Asia-Pacific) materially affect market access and timing of new product launches.
- **Edwards Lifesciences Foundation:** The company's philanthropic arm; the company recorded a \$30.0 million charitable contribution to the Foundation in Q3 2024.

- **Employees:** Approximately 14,000–16,000 employees globally, with compensation and workforce realignment (including a global workforce realignment associated with restructuring charges in 2024–2025) affecting talent retention strategy.

7. Key Risks and Challenges

- **Competitive share erosion in TAVR:** As the U.S. TAVR market matures and growth decelerates, analysts and surveyed cardiologists have flagged the risk that Edwards' TAVR market share could gradually erode as Medtronic, Abbott, and (potentially) a re-entering Boston Scientific intensify competition with new devices and expanded product labels.
- **Litigation and intellectual property expenses:** Edwards recorded substantial intellectual property agreement and litigation-related expenses in 2025 (~\$325.4 million), materially compressing GAAP operating margin and net income versus prior years.
- **Margin and tax volatility:** GAAP operating margin and effective tax rate showed significant quarter-over-quarter volatility in 2025 (e.g., Q4 2025 GAAP operating margin fell to 9.6% from 22.6% a year earlier, and the effective tax rate rose to 29.0% from 11.6%), driven by one-time charges including litigation, impairments, and restructuring.
- **Regulatory and reimbursement dependency:** Growth in key franchises (especially TAVR expansion into earlier-stage/moderate aortic stenosis, and new TMTT products) is highly dependent on FDA approvals and CMS coverage decisions (e.g., the pending TAVR National Coverage Determination update expected Q4 2026), which carry approval-timing and outcome uncertainty.
- **Currency exposure:** With roughly 60% of sales generated outside the United States, Edwards is exposed to foreign exchange fluctuations; the company separately reports constant-currency growth rates to isolate underlying business performance from currency effects.
- **Pipeline execution risk:** A significant share of future growth (particularly in TMTT) depends on successful clinical trial readouts (e.g., PROGRESS, TRISCEND II follow-up data) and timely regulatory approval and commercial launch of next-generation devices (next-gen PASCAL, next-gen EVOQUE, SAPIEN M3).
- **Emerging/low-cost competition:** Analysts note a longer-term risk from emerging low-cost manufacturers, particularly from China and India, that could pressure pricing and regional share over time.
- **Workforce realignment costs:** The company incurred restructuring charges (e.g., \$32.9 million in Q3 2024, \$8.9 million in Q4 2025) tied to severance and global workforce realignment, reflecting ongoing organizational adjustments following the Critical Care divestiture.

8. Quick-Reference Summary

Category	Summary
Company	Edwards Lifesciences Corporation (NYSE: EW); global leader in structural heart innovation
HQ	Irvine, California, USA
CEO	Bernard J. Zovighian (since May 2023)
CFO	Theodora “Doretta” Mistras (since end of May 2026; succeeded Scott B. Ullem)
2025 revenue	~\$6.07 billion (+11.5% YoY)
2026 revenue guidance	~\$6.5–\$6.9 billion (9–11% constant-currency growth)
2026 adjusted EPS guidance	\$2.95–\$3.05
Main product groups	TAVR, TMTT (Transcatheter Mitral and Tricuspid Therapies), Surgical Structural Heart
Market cap (late Aug 2026)	~\$52 billion
Employees	~14,000–16,000 worldwide
Top competitors	Medtronic (TAVR), Abbott (TAVR/mitral/tricuspid), Boston Scientific (TAVR), LivaNova
TAVR market share (global, approx.)	~55–60%; U.S. ~60–72% depending on source/year
Largest institutional shareholders	Vanguard, BlackRock, State Street
Key 2026 catalysts	SAPIEN M3 FDA approval, TAVR NCD update, PASCAL TR approval, PROGRESS trial data at T
Manufacturing locations	Irvine & Draper (USA), Switzerland, Singapore, Costa Rica, Dominican Republic, Puerto Rico, Ire

End of document. This reference was compiled from publicly available sources including SEC filings (Forms 8-K, 10-K/Annual Report, DEF 14A proxy statements), Edwards Lifesciences investor relations materials and press releases, and third-party financial/market-research aggregators. Figures reflect information available as of the September 2026 compilation date and should be cross-checked against Edwards' most recent SEC filings and investor relations site (ir.edwards.com) for the latest updates.